	May 22	Nasser closed the Straits of Tiran to Israeli shipping
	May 30	Jordan signed a defence treaty with Egypt
	June 5–10	Six-Day War
	November	UN Resolution 242
1970		Anwar Sadat became President of Egypt
1973	October 6–24	Yom Kippur War
1978		Camp David Agreement between Egypt and Israel
1979		Treaty of Washington between Egypt and Israel
1981		Assassination of President Sadat

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Israel and its Arab neighbours

Key question
What were the causes of tension on Israel's borders?

Key date
First Arab–Israeli war ended in defeat for Arabs: 1949

The Arab states were stung by their defeat against Israel in 1949. Their peoples felt bitter about their humiliation: it showed how weak and divided they were. It made them bitterly anti-Western. The Arabs felt that the USA had bullied the UN into creating the new state of Israel. They now suspected that the Western powers, such as Britain, France and the USA, would use Israel as a base from which to keep an eye on the Arab states. There was no peace treaty between Israel and any of the Arab states and the ceasefire lines continued to be a source of tension, sometimes fighting.

Israel and Syria

In 1949, the UN had persuaded Israel and Syria to agree to a demilitarised zone along their border. This zone was inside the territory of the new state of Israel and it contained many Arab villages. The Israelis tried to force the Arabs out of some these villages and develop Jewish settlements. The Syrians objected to this. There were frequent incidents of shelling by both sides. There were also disputes over Israel's attempts to divert the waters of the river Jordan in order to irrigate dry parts of the new state.

Israel and Jordan

There was similar tension along the border between Israel and what now became known as the state of Jordan (see the map on page 25). The latter was made up of what had been Transjordan together with the West Bank of the river Jordan now added to it. In 1951 King Abdullah was assassinated by a Muslim fanatic and, after a short reign by his unstable son, his grandson, Hussein, became King in 1953.

The expanded state of Jordan now included a million Palestinian Arabs who were granted full rights as citizens of Jordan. They included many who had fled from their homes in